



**African Chess Academy eth**

# THE STRATEGIC BEGINNER CHESS SYSTEM

Learn Chess the Easy Way While Training Strategic Thinking, Focus, and Smart Decision-Making. The Simplest Way to Learn Chess and Start Thinking Strategically

*Prepared By:*  
**AFRICAN CHESS ACADEMY ET**



+251 930-56 07 07



[t.me/aca\\_eth](https://t.me/aca_eth)

**“Chess is more than a game.  
It’s training for strategic thinking.”**

# THE STRATEGIC **BEGINNER** CHESS SYSTEM

This PDF was designed to make learning chess simple, modern, and beginner-friendly while introducing the foundations of strategic thinking.

Unlike traditional chess guides that overwhelm beginners with complicated theory and memorization, this system focuses on clarity, confidence, and smart thinking from Day 1.

Inside this guide, readers will learn:

- The fundamentals of chess
- How the pieces move
- Core strategic principles
- Chess opening to win Fast your opponent
- Common mistakes to avoid
- Simple habits to improve faster

But this is more than just a chess guide.

It is an introduction to:

- strategic thinking
- focus
- discipline
- patience
- calm decision-making

The goal is not only to teach chess, but to help beginners start thinking more clearly, confidently, and strategically both on and off the board

This PDF is the first step into a modern chess and strategic thinking academy built for future high-level thinkers.

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## Welcome to Strategic Thinking

“Most people think chess is just a game.”

We see it **differently**.

Chess is one of the greatest tools ever created for training:

- focus
- patience
- discipline
- decision-making
- strategic thinking

And that’s exactly what this guide is designed to help you begin developing.

Whether you’ve never touched a chessboard before or you’ve always wanted a simple way to finally understand the game, you’re in the right place.

This guide was created to make chess feel:

- beginner-friendly
- simple
- practical
- modern
- easy to understand

You do NOT need:

- previous experience
- a high rating
- advanced knowledge
- complicated theory

This is not an old-school chess manual filled with overwhelming jargon and endless memorization.

Instead, this is a clear and structured introduction designed to help you:

- understand the fundamentals
- think more strategically
- improve your decision-making
- build confidence move by move

In our academy, we believe chess is more than learning how pieces move.

It’s about learning **how to think**.

- How to stay calm under pressure.
- How to plan ahead.
- How to make smarter decisions.
- How to focus with intention.
- How to think strategically in both games and life.

That is the philosophy behind everything we teach.

*“Our academy teaches chess as a tool for building focus, discipline, and strategic thinking.”*

## Why Chess Is More Than a Game

“Chess isn’t just a like most traditional board game.” Chess is a real training ground for the mind.

Every move teaches you something deeper: how to stay calm, think ahead, focus under pressure, and make better decisions.

### 1. Chess trains patience.

You learn that rushing usually creates mistakes.

### 2. Chess trains planning.

You begin to think ahead instead of reacting to everything emotionally.

### 3. Chess trains focus.

In a world full of distractions, chess teaches concentration and awareness.

### 4. Chess trains decision-making.

Every move has consequences, and over time you learn how to think more carefully before acting.

### 5. Chess also trains emotional control.

You will make mistakes.

You will lose games.

But you learn how to stay composed, adapt, and improve instead of giving up.

That’s why chess has helped millions of people around the world develop discipline, confidence, and stronger thinking skills

## Understanding the Battlefield

Before learning strategy, you must first understand the battlefield.

The chessboard may look complicated at first...  
But once you understand the layout, everything becomes much easier

### The Chessboard

A chessboard has:

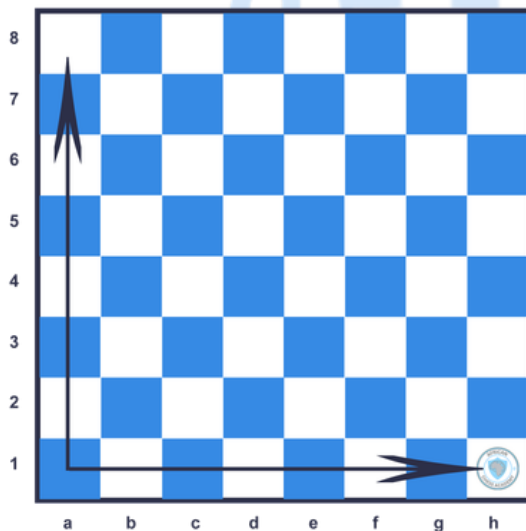
- 64 squares
- 8 rows
- 8 columns

The colors alternate between:

- light squares
- dark squares

This creates the classic checkered pattern.

Think of the board as a battlefield where every piece has a role and every square matters.



### Light & Dark Squares

The board is made of:

- 32 light squares
- 32 dark squares

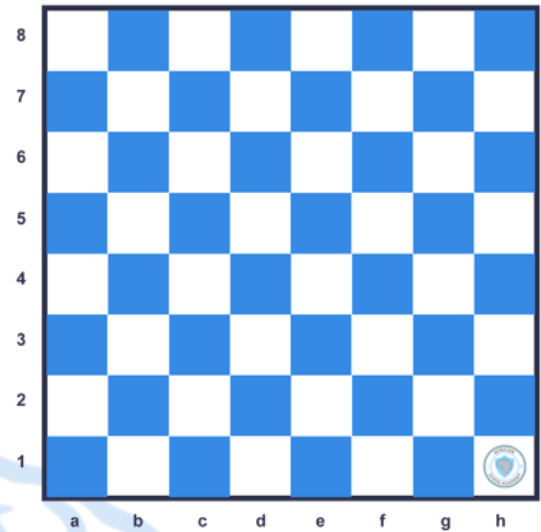
The colors themselves do not change how most pieces move.

But they help organize the board visually.

Some pieces interact with color in important ways later in chess strategy.

For now, just remember:

*Chess is played across both light and dark squares.*



### Correct Board Orientation

This is one of the most important beginner rules. When setting up the board:

The **bottom-right corner** must always be a LIGHT square.

Simple phrase to remember:

***“Light on the right.”***

If the board is turned incorrectly, the entire setup becomes wrong.

Take a moment to check this before every game.

### Understanding Coordinates

Every square on the chessboard has a name.

This system is called:

#### Chess Coordinates

The board is organized using:

- letters
- numbers

#### Rank (Columns)= Letters

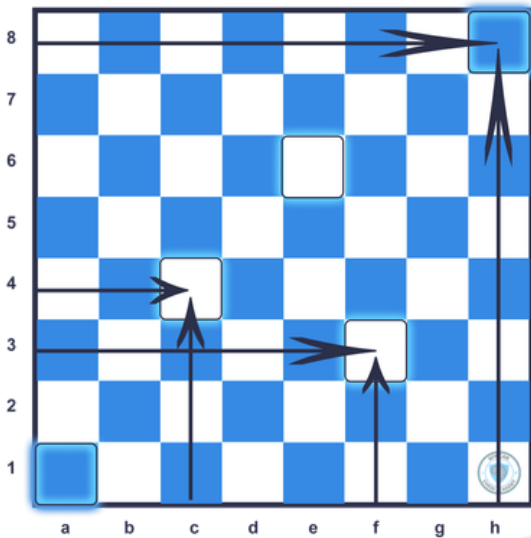
From left to right:

A → B → C → D → E → F → G → H

#### File (Rows) = Numbers

From bottom to top:

1 → 2 → 3 → 4 → 5 → 6 → 7 → 8



## 📌 Example Squares

When a letter and number combine, they create a square name.

Examples:

- A1
- C4
- F3
- H8
- E6

This helps players:

- communicate moves
- study games
- understand positions

Think of it like a map coordinate system.

## 🧠 Beginner Reminder

Do not try to memorize everything instantly.

Your goal right now is simply to:

- recognize the board
- feel comfortable
- understand the layout

*“Confidence comes from repetition.”*

Every strong chess player once started exactly where you are now.

## 🔪 Strategic Thinking Insight

Strong players do not just “see pieces.”

They see:

- space
- patterns
- opportunities
- threats
- control

Understanding the battlefield is the first step toward thinking strategically.



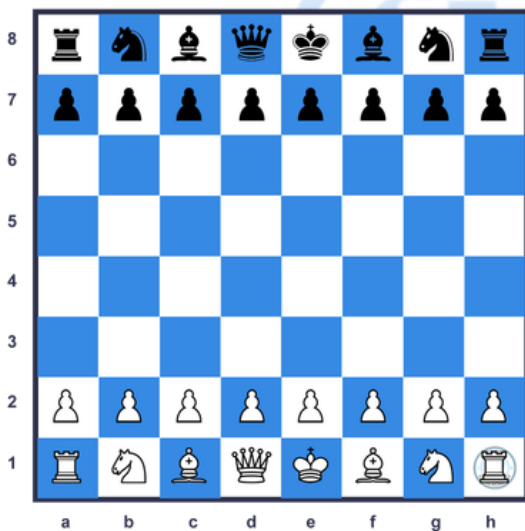
## MEET THE PIECES

Every piece has a role.  
Every role teaches a way of thinking.  
Chess is not just about moving pieces.

It's about learning:

- patience
- planning
- timing
- structure
- creativity
- responsibility

Each piece represents a different strategic skill.  
When you understand the personality of the pieces, chess becomes easier – and much more powerful.

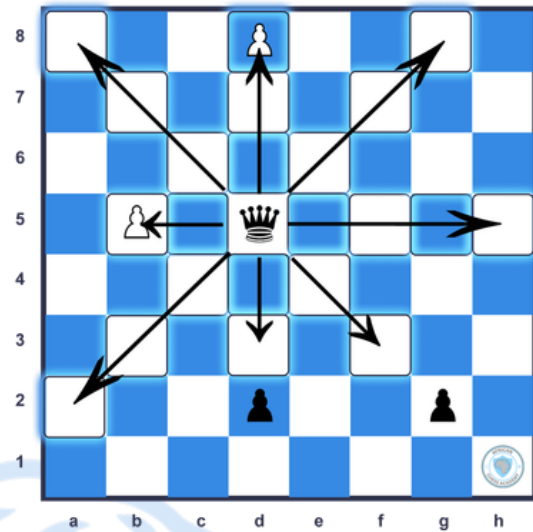


The player with the white pieces moves first and the players then take turns moving. One piece may be moved at each turn except for castling (which is described below).

## Queen Moves

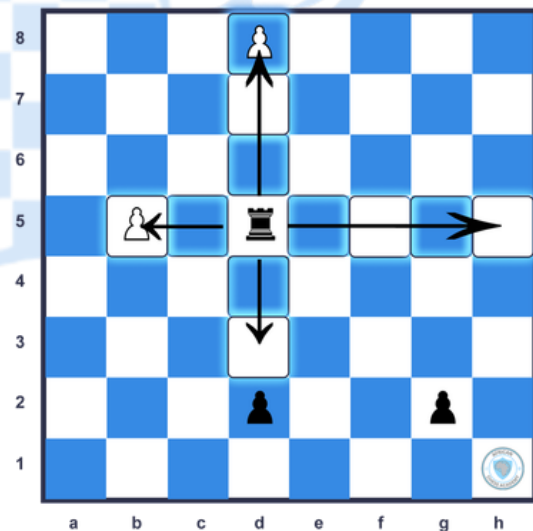
The Queen can move in a straight line any number of squares in any one direction - horizontal, vertical, or diagonal as long as its path is not blocked by its own pieces. It can capture a piece of the opposite color in its path. Below, the black Queen can reach any of the highlighted squares shown in this diagram. It can capture the white Pawn but its path is blocked in some directions—below by the black Pawn and to

the lower right by the black Pawn.



## Rook Moves

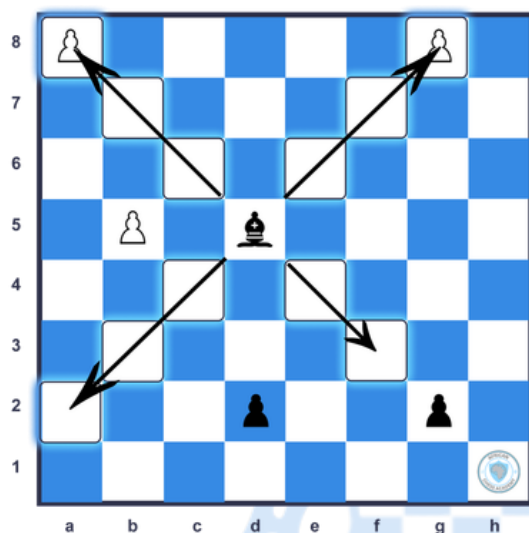
The Rook is the next most powerful piece. The Rook can move any number of squares in one direction – vertically or horizontally– if its path is not blocked. For example, the squares this black Rook can move to the highlighted square in the chessboard below. It can capture the white Pawn to its left but its path is blocked if it wants to move downward—by its black King.



## Bishop Moves

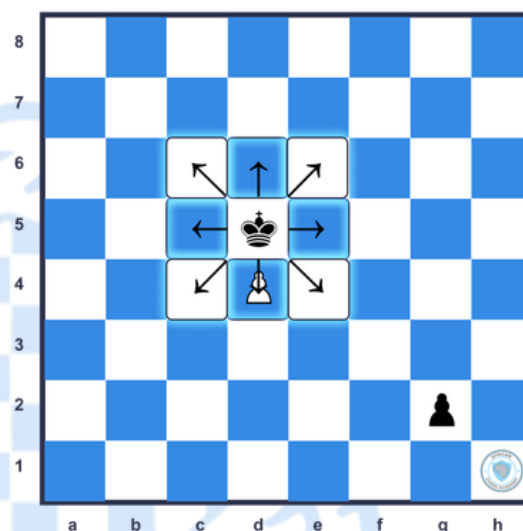
The Bishop can move any number of squares diagonally if its path is not blocked. Note that this Bishop starts on a light square and can reach only other light squares. At the beginning of the game, you have one "dark-square" Bishop

and one "light-square" Bishop. The Bishop's moves are shown by the highlighted squares in the following chessboard. This black Bishop can capture the white pawn but its path is blocked by the black Knight if it wants to move to the lower right.



## ♔ King Moves

The King is the most important piece. When it is trapped, the whole team loses. The King can move one square in any direction - for example, to any of the highlighted squares in this diagram. (An exception is castling, which is explained later.) The King may never move into check - that is, onto a square attacked by an opponent's piece.

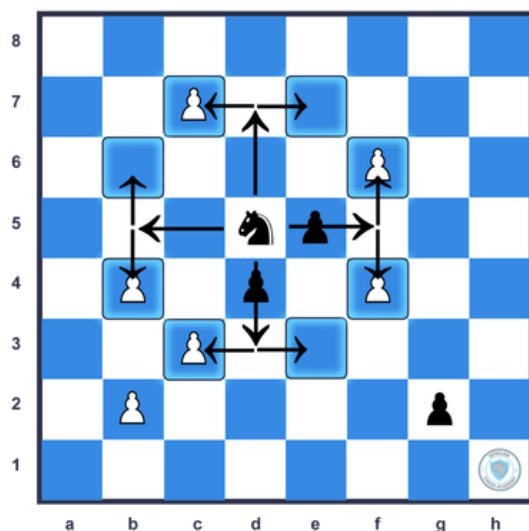


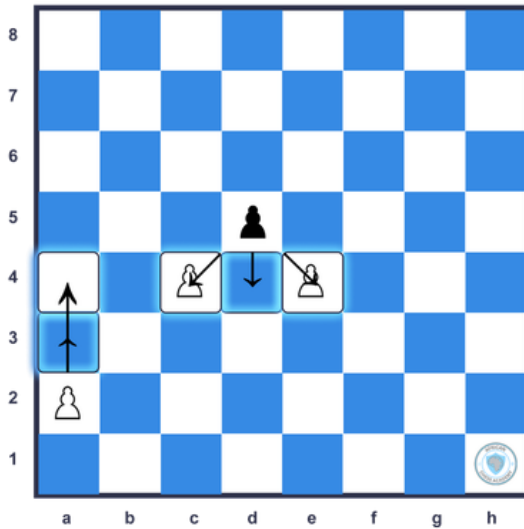
## ♟ Pawn Moves

The Pawn moves straight ahead (never backward), but it captures diagonally. It moves one square at a time, but on its first move it has the option of moving forward one or two squares. In the diagram, the highlighted squares indicate possible destinations for the pawns. The White pawn is on its original square, so it may move ahead either one or two squares. The black Pawn has already moved, so it may move ahead only one square at a time or capture diagonally. The squares on which these black Pawn may capture are indicated by arrows. If a pawn advances all the way to the opposite end of the board, it is immediately "promoted" to another piece, usually a Queen. It may not remain a pawn or become a King. Therefore, it is possible for each player to have more than one Queen or more than two Rooks, Bishops, or Knights on the board at the same time.

## ♞ Knight Moves

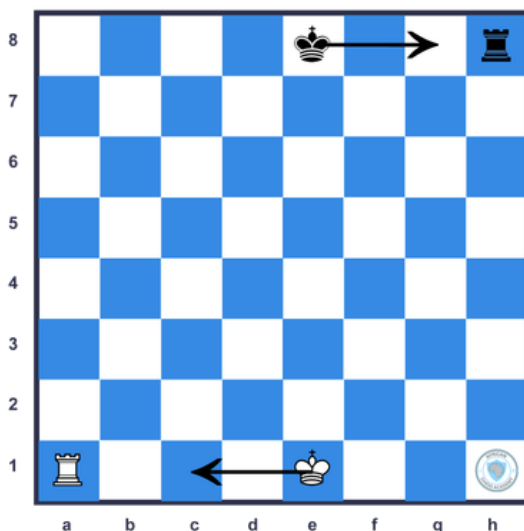
The Knight's move is special. It jumps directly from its old square to its new square. The Knight can jump over other pieces between its old and new squares. Think of the Knight's move as an "L." It moves two squares horizontally or vertically and then makes a right-angle turn for one more square ("2 then 1"). The Knight always lands on a square opposite in color from its old square



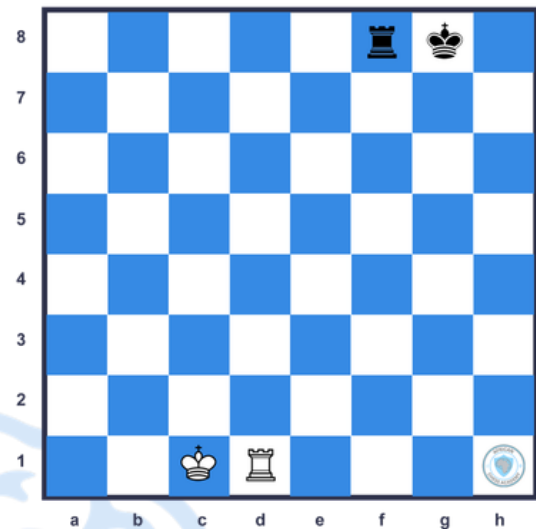


## Castling

Each player may castle only once during a game and only when certain conditions are met. Castling is a special move that lets a player move two pieces at once - the King and one Rook. In castling, the player moves his King two squares either to its left or right toward one of his Rooks. At the same time, the Rook involved goes to the square on the other side of the King. In order to castle, neither the King nor the Rook involved may have moved before. Also, the King may not castle out of check, into check, or through check. Further, there may not be pieces of either color between the King and the Rook involved in castling. The chessboard shown below shows the white King before castling queen-side and the black King before castling king-side

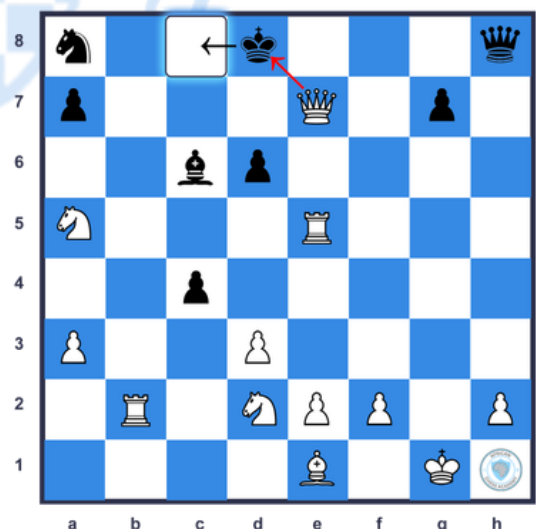


This chessboard shows their position after castling is completed



## Check, Checkmate and Stalemate

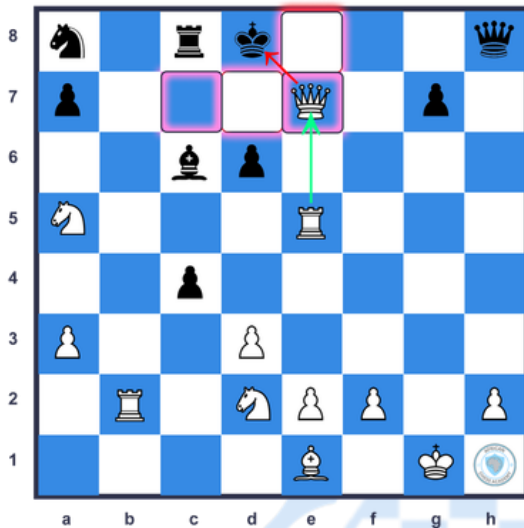
The main goal of chess is to **checkmate** your opponent's King. The King is not actually captured and removed from the board like other pieces. But if the King is attacked, we say it is put in **check** and threatened with capture. It must get out of check immediately. In the chess position shown below, the black King is in check but there is one move that will move the King away from the attacking Queen and that is one highlighted square to the left.



If there is no way to get out of check, the position is a **checkmate** and the side that is checkmated loses. In the position shown below, there is no way for the black King to escape the



attacking white Queen by moving to the highlighted squares. And since the Queen is protected from attack by the white Rook, white wins.



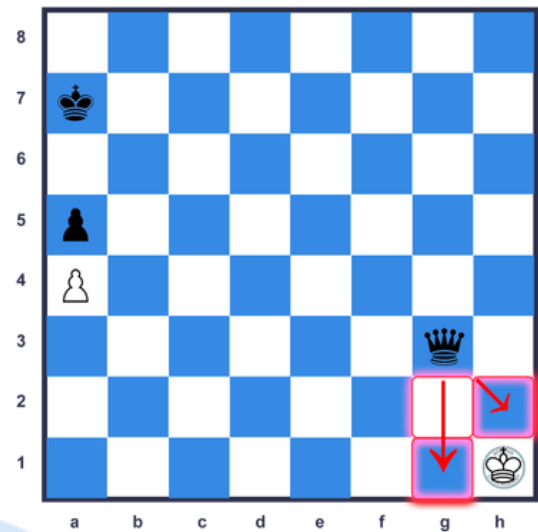
It is illegal for a king to move into check. If your King is in check, there are three ways of getting out of check:

1. Capturing the attacking piece;
2. Placing one of your own pieces between the attacker and your King (impossible if the attacker is a Knight);
3. Moving the King away from the attack.

If a checked player can do none of these, he is **checkmated** and loses the game.

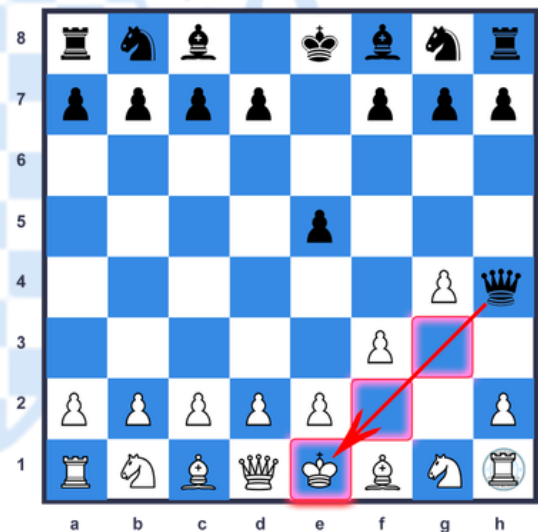
If a King is not in check, and that player can make no legal move, the position is called a **stalemate** and the game is scored as a draw, or tie, with each player receiving a half point.

In the chessboard show below, it is white's turn to move and since there are no moves for the white pawn and every move puts the white King into check, we say the game is a **stalemate**



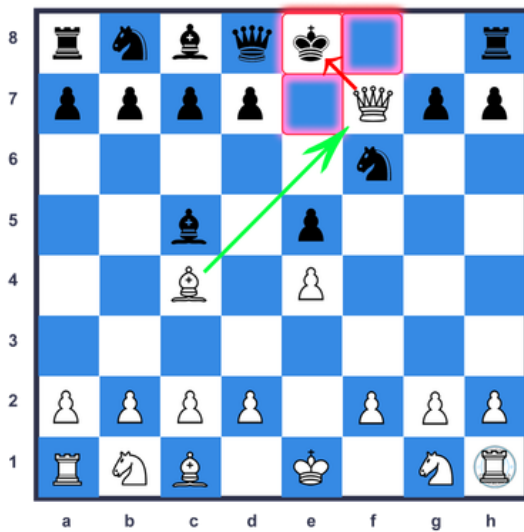
## Chess Openings to Win fast

**Fool's Mate** is the fastest checkmating pattern that can occur in chess and can happen after just two moves. 1. f3 e5 2. g4 Qh4#



It is possible to achieve it only if White makes terrible opening mistakes, and that is why people call it Fool's Mate. Only Black can deliver this mate in two moves, although White can also win the game in three moves in a similar fashion.

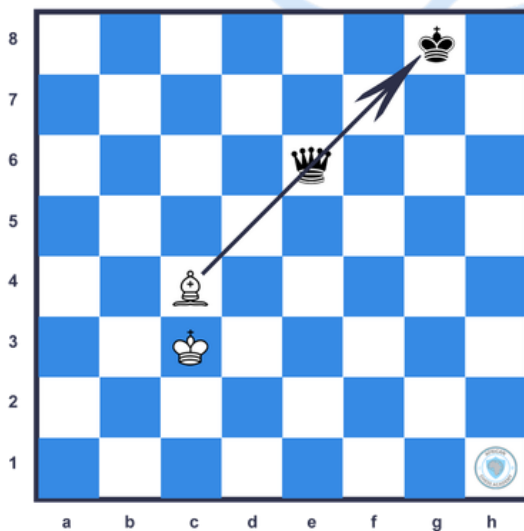
**Scholar's Mate** Like the Fool's Mate, it is one of the fastest ways a player can checkmate their opponent in chess. It occurs after 1.e4 e5 2.Bc4 (targeting f7) Nc6 3.Qh5 (adding another attacker to the f7-pawn) Nf6?? 4.Qxf7#.



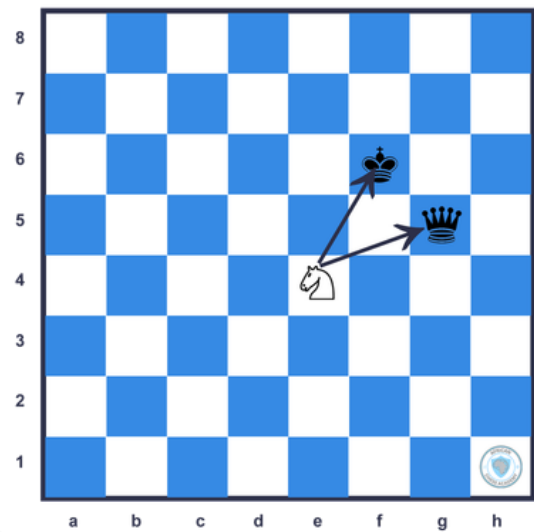
The Scholar's Mate is common among beginners, and most players have fallen for it or won a game with it at one point in their lives.

## Simple Tactics Must to Know

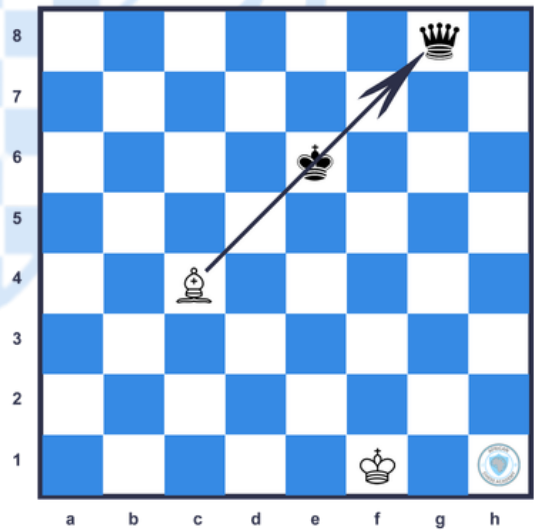
A **Pin** occurs when a piece is attacked and if it moves, a piece of greater value will be under attack. So the piece is said to be pinned to its position as shown in the following diagram:



A **Fork** occurs when a piece (not always a knight!) attacks two or more pieces at the same time as shown in the following diagram:



A **Skewer** is similar to a pin except in this case the piece of greater value (for example, the King, Queen or Rook) is in front. An enemy piece attacks the piece and when this piece moves away, it leaves a piece of lesser value exposed to capture. Below the Bishop is Skewering the Black King and Queen. The King must move out of check and the White Bishop captures the Black Queen!



## Basic Opening Strategy

- Control the center
- develop a piece early
- Develop Minor Pieces before Major Pieces
- Try not to move a piece more than once
- Do not bring your queen out early.
- do not sacrifice material except it's calculated

## You're Not Just Learning Chess

### You're Not Just Learning Chess

Most people think chess is only about winning games. But the real value of chess goes far beyond the board.

Every game trains the way you think.

Every move teaches patience, awareness, planning, and decision-making.

That's why chess has been respected for generations by leaders, competitors, thinkers, and high performers around the world.

In chess, every move has consequences.

You learn to:

- pause before acting
- think ahead
- recognize patterns
- stay focused under pressure
- adapt when situations change

Over time, this changes the way you approach challenges — not only in chess, but in life.

You begin to think more clearly, more calmly, and more strategically.

## Join the Academy Community

You are not learning alone.

You are entering a global community of students, thinkers, competitors, and future leaders who are training their minds through chess, discipline, and strategic thinking.

Our academy was built for people who want more than casual entertainment.

It was built for people who want to:

- Think more clearly
- Improve focus
- Make smarter decisions
- Build discipline
- Develop strategic awareness
- Grow alongside ambitious thinkers around the world

## Inside the Community You'll Get:

### Beginner Training & Guidance

Simple lessons, tips, and systems designed to help you improve without confusion or overwhelm.

### Strategic Thinking Challenges

Train your ability to think ahead, stay calm under pressure, and make smarter decisions.

### Daily Motivation & Discipline

Build consistency, focus, and mental strength with a community moving in the same direction.

### Improvement Systems

Learn practical frameworks to improve faster and avoid the mistakes most beginners make.

### Global Community Access

Connect with future strategic thinkers from around the world through discussion, challenges, and learning.

## Final Message

Chess is only the beginning.

The real goal is to build:

- Focus
- Patience
- Strategic awareness
- Discipline
- Calm decision-making
- A stronger way of thinking

This community exists for people who want to grow mentally, strategically, and personally — one move at a time.

Welcome to the academy.

**“Strategic thinkers are not born.  
They are trained.”**



“This guide is only the beginning.  
Strategic thinking is a skill that changes how you  
learn, decide, compete, and grow.”

## Continue Your Training →



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[t.me/aca\\_eth](https://t.me/aca_eth)